

One Issue, One Review Decision

A bounded Copilot cloud agent workflow

Today's journey

```
issue contract
  ↓
repository setup
  ↓
proposed change
  ↓
test evidence
  ↓
human decision
```

Keep the same issue and acceptance criteria at every step.

Access policy

The live route requires:

- approved Copilot cloud agent access;
- a training repository with synthetic data;
- a named reviewer;
- a bounded issue and stop condition.

If one requirement is missing, use the manual route. Do not bypass policy.

The fixed issue

Reject blank task titles

Allowed files:

- `src/app.js`
- `tests/app.test.js`

Required command:

```
npm test
```

No dependency changes. No unrelated refactor.

Checkpoint 1: Issue contract

The reviewer must answer:

- Which behavior changes?
- Which behavior stays the same?
- Which files may change?
- What proves completion?
- What is out of scope?

Assignment waits until every answer is clear.

Repository instructions

Repository instructions help the agent work efficiently:

- project shape;
- coding conventions;
- allowed file scope;
- test command;
- prohibited changes.

Instructions support the issue. They do not repair a vague issue.

Copilot setup steps

The workflow file belongs at:

```
.github/workflows/copilot-setup-steps.yml
```

It uses one job named:

```
copilot-setup-steps
```

Review permissions, commands, and secrets before merging it to the default branch.

Checkpoint 2: Setup

Record:

- baseline test result;
- repository instructions location;
- setup workflow location;
- allowed files;
- reviewer and stop condition.

Stop when the baseline is unexplained or setup requires unapproved access.

Start or simulate the session

Live route:

- assign the fixed issue through an approved entry point;
- watch the session log;
- steer only within the issue;
- stop on scope drift.

Manual route:

- implement the same issue locally;
- preserve the same file scope and tests.

Checkpoint 3: Proposed change

Inspect before running tests:

- changed files;
- validation behavior;
- response shape;
- valid request behavior;
- dependency and configuration changes.

A small diff can still be wrong.

The expected behavior

```
if (typeof title !== "string" || title.trim() === "") {  
  return res.status(400).json({ error: "title is required" });  
}
```

The exact code may differ. The observable behavior and constraints may not.

Checkpoint 4: Tests

Required cases:

Case	Expected
" "	HTTP 400
" "	HTTP 400
" Weekly plan "	HTTP 201 with preserved response shape

Run the full supplied suite and record the command output.

Review feedback stays bounded

Good:

The whitespace case is missing. Add a focused test in tests/app.test.js.
Keep the current response shape and do not change other endpoints.
Run npm test and report the result.

Bad:

Clean up the API while you are there.

Checkpoint 5: Human decision

Choose:

- **approve** when criteria, scope, and tests pass;
- **request changes** when a bounded correction remains;
- **pause** when access, evidence, or ownership is unresolved.

The agent does not make this decision.

Stop conditions

Stop the live route when:

- the requested files expand;
- a new dependency appears;
- credentials or unapproved data are requested;
- tests loop without a bounded recovery;
- the issue changes during implementation;
- the reviewer is no longer available.

Prepared fallback

The solution folder contains:

- the final issue contract;
- reviewed setup workflow;
- proposed diff;
- runnable solution project;
- test evidence;
- completed human decision.

Use it when a live session is delayed. Label it as prepared evidence.

Lab handoff

One issue. Five checkpoints. One accountable decision.